

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF ADDICTION COUNSELOR EXAMINERS AND THE STATE
BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case Nos. 2020-5564 & 2020-5565

STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER

IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE CERTIFICATION TO
PRACTICE ADDICTION COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO AND THE LICENSE TO
PRACTICE PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF STEPHEN
WESTRA, CERTIFICATION NO. ACC 250, LICENSE NO. LPC 186,

Respondent.

IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Addiction
Counselor Examiners and the State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor
Examiners (together, "Boards") and Stephen Westra ("Respondent"), as follows:

1. The Boards have jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order ("Order").
2. Respondent was certified to practice as an addiction specialist ("CAS III") and licensed to practice as a professional counselor ("LPC") the State of Colorado at all times relevant herein.
3. It is the intent of the parties and the purpose of this Order to provide for a settlement of all matters arising out of the complaint in case numbers 2020-5564 and 2020-5565 without the necessity of holding a formal hearing. This Order is a full and final resolution of case numbers 2020-5564 and 2020-5565. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Boards or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.
4. Respondent admits the following:
 - a. On or about August 13, 2020, Respondent made inappropriate comments of a sexual nature regarding a client's body.
5. By virtue of the admissions in paragraph 4 above, Respondent admits and the Boards find that Respondent violated section 12-245-224(1)(g)(I), C.R.S., which states:

12-245-224. Prohibited activities--related provisions. (1) A person licensed, registered, or certified under this article 245 violates this article 245 if he or she:

(g)(I) Has acted or failed to act in a manner that does not meet the generally accepted standards of the professional discipline under which the person practices. Generally accepted standards may include, at the board's discretion, the standards of practice generally recognized by state and national associations of practitioners in the field of the person's professional discipline.

6. By virtue of the admissions in paragraphs 4 and 5 above, Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanction(s) that the Boards believe is necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

ADMONISHMENT

7. On the basis of the findings set forth in paragraphs 4 and 5, the Boards hereby admonish Respondent for a violation of section 12-245-224(1)(g)(I), C.R.S. This Order is effective as a Letter of Admonition, set forth by section 12-20-404(4), C.R.S. As part of the admonishment, Respondent agrees to the following terms as a Board Order:

CONTINUING EDUCATION

8. Within twelve (12) months of the effective date of this Order, Respondent must successfully complete twenty (20) hours of Board-approved professional continuing education ("CE") courses in the areas of ethics and boundaries. Respondent shall obtain Board approval of the courses prior to enrolling in each course. Upon completion of a course, Respondent shall ensure that a certificate of completion is provided to the Boards. These hours of CE completed pursuant to this section shall be required in addition to, and may not be counted toward, the mandatory Continuing Professional Development requirements for an active Colorado license or certification or to meet any other licensure or certification requirements.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

9. Respondent will strictly observe the prohibitions set forth in section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and will ensure that he does not engage in any activities that are prohibited and that he practices in accordance with the generally accepted standards of practice.

10. All expenses incurred or associated with education or any other requirement necessary to fulfill the terms of this Order, shall be the sole responsibility of Respondent and not the Boards.

11. In the event Respondent relocates at any time prior to completing the terms of this Order, Respondent shall notify the Boards of the change of address within 30 days of the effective date of such change.

12. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

13. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

14. This Order shall become an order of the Boards when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representatives.

15. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S.

16. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

17. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Boards. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

18. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Boards, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with

the Boards. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Boards.

19. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Boards.

20. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Boards.

AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT

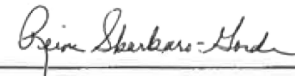

STEPHEN WESTRA
CERTIFICATION No. ACC 250
LICENSE No. LPC 186

APPROVED AS TO FORM
FOR RESPONDENT


ROBERT A. LEES
Robert A. Lees & Associates

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

STATE BOARD OF ADDICTION COUNSELOR
EXAMINERS AND THE STATE BOARD OF
LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR
EXAMINERS


REINA SBARBARO-GORDON
Program Director

Effective this 30th day of December,
2020.